

Asian small-clawed otter

*Aonyx cinereus*

- ↔ 29–37 in (73–95 cm)
- 📍 W., E., C., and southern Asia
- ⊗ Vulnerable

The claws of this small otter are so short that they do not protrude beyond the fleshy pads of its webbed feet. It feeds mainly on mussels, clams, and crabs, catching them in its forefeet and crushing them with its broad cheek teeth; it also eats large insects, frogs, rodents, and small fish. Small-clawed otters live in extended family groups of about 12, which can often be seen

playing on riverbanks. Male-female pair bonds in these groups are especially strong.



outer guard hairs provide water-proofing

Falanouc

*Eupleres goudotii*

- ↔ 19–22 in (48–56 cm)
- 📍 E. and N. Madagascar
- ⊗ Near threatened

Restricted to tropical rainforests and marshes on the island of Madagascar, this elusive hunter has a bushy tail and a long, slim snout. Its tiny, cane-shaped teeth are flattened to cope with gripping slimy invertebrate prey such as earthworms and slugs. Its single young is born with its eyes open and is able to follow its mother after only two days.

long, muscular tail

Yellow mongoose

*Cynictis penicillata*

- ↔ 9–13 in (23–33 cm)
- 📍 Southern Africa
- ⊗ Common

Similar to the meerkat, the yellow mongoose also has a habit of standing on its hindlegs for a better view of its surroundings and possible danger. It often occupies a burrow system—originally dug by meerkats—and sometimes shares it with them. The mongoose lives in extended family groups, each comprising a main breeding pair, their young, and nonbreeding adults. It preys on small animals—mainly insects such as termites, beetles, and locusts, but also frogs, lizards, birds, and mice.

Banded mongoose

*Mungos mungo*

- ↔ 12–18 in (30–45 cm)
- 📍 Africa
- ⊗ Common

This sociable mongoose is named for the pattern of dark bands across its brownish gray back. Widespread across Africa in open forests and grasslands, it lives in groups of 20 or so that forage together, twittering and chirping as they seek out food such as insects and other small animals. It also eats bird eggs, cracking open the shells by throwing them against rocks.



Common palm civet

*Paradoxurus hermaphroditus*

- ↔ 17–28 in (43–71 cm)
- 📍 S., E., and SE. Asia
- ⊗ Common

Grayish brown, but mottled with darker spots and black stripes, and with a dark mask across its face, this bushy-tailed civet is widespread across a varied range of habitats. It mainly eats small animals and fruit—especially figs and the fermented juice of palm tree flowers. An accomplished climber, it often takes refuge in a tree or roof by day, searching for food at night.



Common genet

*Genetta genetta*

- ↔ 16–22 in (40–55 cm)
- 📍 W., E., and Southern Africa, W. Europe
- ⊗ Common

The slender, sharp-faced common genet has a body with bold black spots and a long, black-banded tail, like that of a raccoon. It climbs like a cat and forages mainly at night for a variety of small mammals, birds, eggs, insect grubs, and fruit. By day, it hides away in a hollow tree or a den made in a tangle of roots among dense bushes. Adaptable and opportunistic, it has a wide distribution ranging from South Africa to central France.

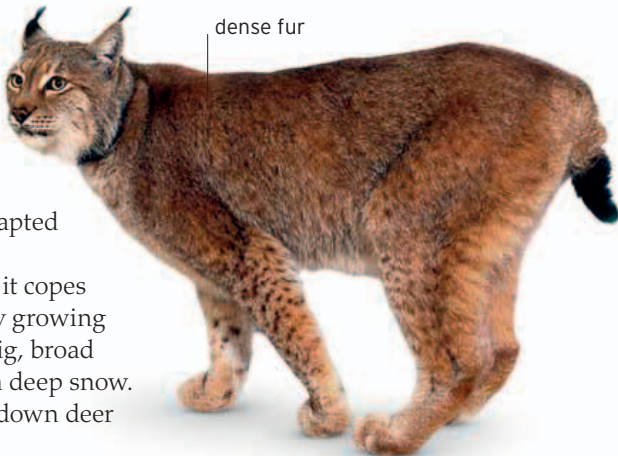
Eurasian lynx

*Lynx lynx*

- ↔ 3–4 ft (0.9–1.2 m)
- 📍 N. Europe to E. Asia
- ⊗ Common

This is the biggest of the four lynx species, with a striped, spotted, or plain yellow-brown coat, and prominent black ear tufts. The lynx is adapted for life in the northern Eurasian forests, where it copes with the cold winters by growing an extra-long coat; its big, broad feet enable it to walk on deep snow. Unusually, it can bring down deer

and similar prey up to four times its own size, but it also hunts smaller animals such as hares.



dense fur